

AGERATUM

and produces tight clusters of deep violet-blue flower heads. ‘**Swing Pink**’ is dwarf with attractive, pink flower heads.

AGLAONEMA

Chinese evergreen

ARACEAE

Genus of evergreen, erect, tufted perennials, grown mainly for their foliage. Tolerates shade, although the variegated forms need more light, and prefers moist but well-drained soil. Water moderately in full growth, less in winter. Propagate by division or stem cuttings in summer. Mealy bug may be a problem. **A. commutatum.** Evergreen, erect, tufted perennial. H and S 20in (50cm). Broadly lance-shaped leaves, 12in (30cm) long, are dark green with irregular, grayish-white patches along lateral veins. Bears greenish-white spathes in summer. Z14–15. (min. 55°F/13°C). ‘**Malay Beauty**’ (syn. A.c. ‘Pewter’) bears very dark green leaves mottled greenish-white and cream.Z15. ‘**Pewter**’ see A.c. ‘Malay Beauty’. ‘**Treubii**’ illus. p.468. **A. pictum** illus. p.475. **A. ‘Silver King**’ illus. p.475.

AGONIS

Willow myrtle

MYRTACEAE

Genus of evergreen, mainly spring-flowering shrubs and small trees, grown for their foliage, flowers, and graceful appearance. Needs full light and well-drained but moisture-retentive soil. Water containerized plants moderately, scarcely at all in winter. Pruning tolerated when necessary. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. **A. flexuosa** (Peppermint tree, Willow myrtle) illus. p.450.

AGROSTEMMA

Corn cockle

CARYOPHYLLACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals. Grow in sun; flowers best in very well-drained soil that is not very fertile. Support with sticks and deadhead to prolong flowering. Propagate by seed sown *in situ* in spring or early fall. ☉ Seeds may cause severe discomfort if ingested. **A. coeli-rosa.** See *Silene coeli-rosa*. **A. githago.** Fast-growing, erect annual with thin stems. H 2–3ft (60–90cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green leaves and, in summer, produces 5-petaled, open trumpet-shaped, pink flowers, 3in (8cm) across. Tiny, rounded, dark brown seeds are poisonous. Z4–10. ‘**Milas**’ illus. p.304.

AICHRYSON

CRASSULACEAE

Genus of annual and perennial succulents, often shrublike, grown for their fleshy, spoon-shaped to rounded, hairy leaves. Most species are short-lived, dying after flowering. Requires a position in full sun or partial shade and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

A. x aizoides var. domesticum ‘Variegatum’, syn. A. x *domesticum* ‘Variegatum’, illus. p.495.

AILANTHUS

SIMAROUBACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and 3–5-winged fruits. They are extremely tolerant of urban pollution. Needs sun or semishade and deep, fertile, well-drained soil. To grow as shrubs, cut back hard in spring, after which vigorous shoots bearing very large leaves are produced. Propagate by seed sown in fall or by suckers or root cuttings taken in winter. ☉ Male flowers are unpleasantly scented; the pollen may cause an allergic reaction. **A. altissima,** syn. A. *glandulosa* (Tree of heaven), illus. p.63. **A. glandulosa.** See A. *altissima*.

AJUGA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, some of which are semievergreen or evergreen and excellent as groundcover. Tolerates sun or shade and any soil, but is more vigorous in moist conditions. Propagate by division in spring. **A. pyramidalis** (Pyramidal bugle). Evergreen or semievergreen perennial. H 6–10in (15–25cm), S 18–24in (45–60cm). Forms a creeping carpet of oblong to spoon-shaped, deep green leaves. Bears spikes of whorled, 2-lipped, blue flowers in spring. Z3–9. ‘**Metallica Crispa**’ has crisp, curled leaves, with a metallic-bronze lustre, and bears dark blue flowers. **A. reptans ‘Atropurpurea’.** Evergreen, groundcover perennial, spreading freely by runners. H 6in (15cm), S 24–36in (60–90cm). Has small rosettes of ovate to oblong-spoon-shaped, toothed or slightly lobed, glossy, deep bronze-purple leaves. Short spikes of 2-lipped, blue flowers are borne in spring. Z3–9. ‘**Catlin’s Giant**’ has very large, dark bronze-purple leaves, to 6in (15cm) long, and produces inflorescences to 8in (20cm) long. ‘**Jungle Beauty**’ has large, dark green leaves, sometimes suffused purple. ‘**Multicolor**’ (syn. A.r. ‘Rainbow’) has dark bronze-green leaves, marked with cream and pink. ‘**Rainbow**’ see A.r. ‘Multicolor’.

AKEBIA

LARDIZABALACEAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen, woody-stemmed, twining climbers, grown for their leaves and flowers. Individual plants seldom bear fruits; cross-pollination between 2 plants is needed for fruit to form. Hardy, but late frost may damage the flowers. Prefers full sun and any good, well-drained soil. Dislikes disturbance. May be propagated by seed sown in fall or spring; by semiripe cutings taken in summer; or by layering in winter. **A. lobata.** See A. *trifoliata*. **A. longeracemosa.** Twining, semievergreen climber. H 20ft (6m). Rounded leaves comprise 5 leaflets, to 3½in (9cm) long. In spring, produces racemes, to 7in (18cm) long, of vanilla-

scented, brownish-purple flowers, followed by sausage-shaped, reddish-purple fruits. Z5–9 **A. x pentaphylla** illus. p.194. **A. quinata** (Chocolate vine) illus. p.193. ‘**White Chocolate**’ is a semievergreen, woody-stemmed climber. H 30ft (10m). Rounded leaves, with 5 leaflets, are dark green above, blue-green below, tinged purple in winter. Bears pendent racemes, to 5in (12cm) long, of purple-tinged, white flowers, with chocolate-brown filaments, in early spring, then dull, white fruits. Z4–9 **A. trifoliata,** syn. A. *lobata*, illus. p.204.

ALANGIUM

CORNACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen trees and shrubs, grown for their foliage and flowers. Needs full sun and any fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by sowing seed in spring or by taking softwood cuttings in summer. **A. platanifolium.** Deciduous, upright, treelike shrub. H 10ft (3m), S 6ft (2m). Produces maplelike, 3-lobed, mid-green leaves. Fragrant, tubular, white flowers are borne from early to midsummer. Z7–8

ALBIZIA

MIMOSACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of deciduous or semievergreen trees, grown for their feathery foliage and unusual flower heads, composed of numerous stamens and resembling bottlebrushes. Best against a warm, sunny wall; in cold regions, do not plant out until late spring. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. **A. julibrissin** may be grown as a summer bedding plant for its foliage. Propagate by seed in fall. **A. distachya.** See *Paraserianthes lophantha*. **A. julibrissin** (Silk tree). Deciduous, spreading, large shrub or small tree. H 12–25ft (4–8m), S 8–12ft (2.5–4m). Large, fernlike, light to mid-green leaves are divided into many leaflets. Bears clusters of fluffy, spherical, yellow-green flower heads, in late summer or fall. Z6–9. **f. rosea** illus. p.86. ‘**Summer Chocolate**’, H 15ft (5m), S 12ft (4m), is a vigorous, widely arching selection with leaves that are bronze-green in spring, maturing to deep maroon-purple by midsummer, contrasting with the pinkish-purple, white-centered flowers; good for a large container or train against a wall. **A. lophantha.** See *Paraserianthes lophantha*.

ALBUCA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of spring- or summer-flowering bulbs. Needs an open, sunny position and well-drained soil. Dies down in spring or late summer after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring or by offsets when dormant. **A. humilis** illus. p.422. **A. shawii.** Midsummer-flowering bulb. H 6–24in (15–60cm), S 3in (8cm). Has 6–12 narrowly linear leaves, 4–6in (10–15cm) long. Produces racemes of 3–9 narrowly bell-shaped, pendent yellow flowers, ¾in (1.5cm) across. Z7–11

ALCEA

Hollyhock

MALVACEAE

Genus of biennials and short-lived perennials, grown for their tall spikes of flowers. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in late summer or spring. Rust may be a problem. **A. rosea,** syn. *Althaea rosea*. Erect biennial. H 5–8ft (1.5–2.5m), S to 2ft (60cm). Has rounded, lobed, rough-textured leaves. Spikes of single flowers, in a range of colors, including pink, yellow and cream, are borne in summer and early fall. Z3–9. **Chater’s Double Group,** H 6–8ft (2–2.5m), bears double flowers in several different colors in summer and early fall. **Halo Series** has flowers with a ring of contrasting color around the yellow center. ‘**Majorette**’, H 3ft (1m), S to 1ft (30cm), produces double flowers, in several different colors, in summer and early fall. **Summer Carnival Group** (annual or biennial), H 6–8ft (1.8–2.4m), S to 2ft (60cm), has double flowers in mixed colors.

ALCHEMILLA

Lady’s mantle

ROSACEAE

Genus of perennials that produce sprays of tiny, greenish-yellow flowers, with conspicuous outer calyces, in summer. Some are good for groundcover. Grow in sun or partial shade, in all but boggy soils. Propagate by seed or division in spring or fall. **A. alpina** (Alpine lady’s mantle). Mound-forming perennial. H 3–5in (8–12cm), S 20in (50cm). Rounded, lobed, pale green leaves are covered in silky hairs. Bears upright spikes of tiny, greenish-yellow flowers, with conspicuous, green, outer calyces, in summer. Suitable for groundcover and a dry bank. Z3–7 **A. conjuncta** illus. p.275. **A. erythropoda.** Clump-forming perennial. H 8–12in (20–30cm), S 8in (20cm). Has rounded, shallowly lobed, sharp-toothed, hairy, bluish-green leaves. Cymes of yellowish green flowers are produced from late spring to late summer. Z3–9 **A. mollis** (Lady’s mantle) illus. p.275.

X ALICEARA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS. **x A. Dark Warrior.** Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 10in (25cm). Produces sprays of wispy, mauve-brown, cream-yellow or green flowers, 1½in (4cm) across; flowering season varies. Leaves, 4in (10cm) long, are narrowly ovate. Grow in semishade in summer. Z15 (min. 59°F/15°C)

ALLAMANDA

syn. ALLEMANDA

APOCYNACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and woody-stemmed, scrambling climbers, grown for their trumpet-shaped flowers. Prefers partial shade in summer and humus-rich,